

Citadel Journal Issue 1

BLOOD AND IRON

Dwarf Runesmiths & Engineers



MAN O' WAR

BLOOD AND IRON

By Gavin Thorpe

Over the next issues of the Journal we will be publishing a series of articles expanding on the rules for different races in your Man O' War battles. This issue we deal with the mighty Dwarf steamships.

Sometimes a Dwarf fleet is accompanied by a Runesmith, whose potent abilities can aid his clansmen in battle. Before launch a Runesmith can forge special cannon and armour plates that have powerful Runes cast upon them. The mighty Ironclads and Dreadnoughts are the pride of any Dwarf fleet and are sometimes home to their original builders, an ingenious and talented Master Engineer. With his constant tinkering and ability to patch up damage that would baffle lesser technicians he is forever improving the ships ability to fight.

RUNESMITHS.

The Runesmith is the Dwarfs equivalent of an Elf Mage or a Chaos Sorcerer. Using ancient signs and sigils called Runes they can imbue items with a magical power. The tunnels and chambers of Barak Varr echo to the sound of hammers on anvils, but occasionally this is drowned out by the deep and sonorous chanting of a Runesmith creating artefacts of power for a new vessel. Since the Runesmith is asked by the fleets Admiral to give his services many accompany their kindred as part of their payment. The opportunity to meet new races and see new sights is sometimes enough to tempt even the most old and venerable of this order.

All Dwarf ships carry Engineers on board but a few special vessels have a mighty Runesmith as part of its complement. Runesmiths can cast potent Runes onto the weapons and armour plating of a ship, making it even more powerful than its less enhanced sister ships. The Runesmith has special abilities which will enhance the performance of any fleet he is with.

As well as using magic for themselves, Dwarf Runesmiths are adept at thwarting the abilities of more magically-attuned races such as Elves and Humans. A fleet with a Runesmith will dispel incoming spells on a roll of 5 or 6 instead of 6. Runesmiths also carry many items which can bend the forces of nature to their will. The presence of a Runesmith adds +1 to your chances of summoning a Sea Monster. He is worth two battle honours. In addition, the presence of a Runesmith allows the Dwarf player to purchase abilities for his Men O' War, chosen from the Rune cards below. You may buy up to two Runes from each category per ship. Certain Runes may be bought more than once, their effect being cumulative (E. g. a Rune of Piercing bought twice would inflict a -2 save modifier). The price of each Rune is given on the appropriate Rune card. Each Rune also modifies the Battle Honours awarded to your opponent if the ship is sunk, as stated on the card. There are three types of Rune, as below. Cannon Runes and Runic Shot are known collectively as Weapon Runes.

Cannon Runes

Cannon Runes are bought for a particular turret or battery and will apply to all shots made by that location. The word 'turret' has been used on some occasions but a broadside battery has the same bonuses. Broadside cannon will have one dice roll on each side using the special Rune. There is a marker that should be placed on the appropriate location on the ships template. If the location is destroyed you may not use the Rune cannon until it has been repaired.

Runic Shot

The powers that can be used once are embossed onto cannonballs that must be loaded specially. At the start of the turn you must declare that the ship has the Runic shot loaded. When using Runic Shot ALL shots fired by the ship on that turn are using that ammunition. If you buy two sets of the same Runic Shot the effect is not cumulative, they are two separate loads.

Hull Runes.

Hull Runes are embossed upon the armour plates that cover the outside of the ships Hull. They can add protection for the ship against physical and magical attacks. Hull Runes last for the duration of the battle.

Remember that an unmodified roll of one will always fail and a natural six will always succeed, regardless of Runes, Magic, or other factors.

DWARF FLEET

Runesmith: 0- 1

The fleet may include up to one Runesmith who is on the Admirals Flagship.

Cost: 50 points for one Runesmith.

Master Engineer: 0+

You may buy a Master Engineer for each Man O' War in your fleet. He is placed with a single Man O' War and allows you to buy a maximum of two Master Engineer cards for that ship.

Cost: 25 points per Master Engineer.

Slayers: 0- 1

You may have one contingent of Slayers for your Admirals flagship.

Cost: 50 points for one contingent.

MASTER ENGINEERS.

Dwarf Engineers are famed throughout the world for their ingenuity and skill. The heads of the Engineers Guilds are known as Master Engineers and their technical knowledge and achievement is only surpassed by their twisted cousins, the Chaos Dwarfs. An Admiral may buy a Master Engineer for each Man O' War in his fleet. A Master Engineer allows you to re-roll the dice when attempting to repair a location. The second roll is final. A Master Engineer allows you to attempt repairs on below the waterline damage, though a six is needed to be successful and the roll may not be re-rolled.

As well as the above bonuses the Master Engineer may equip the ship with any of the mechanical improvements detailed on the Master Engineer cards that follow. Pay the points listed on the card. Only two of the following improvements can be bought for a single ship, though if two or more ships have Master Engineers they may buy the same improvements. The effects of the Engineer cards are not cumulative so it is pointless to buy more than one of a single type for a ship. Master Engineer cards add to the number of Battle Honours the Man O' War is worth. The additional Battle Honours awarded to your opponent when it is sunk are written on the Engineer cards.

Picking up survivors.

There are counters for your Runesmith and Master Engineers that are to be placed on the appropriate ships template. If that ship is sunk the counters will be placed on the wreckage like a Wizard or Admiral marker and can be picked up as detailed in the Man O' War rulebook

SLAYERS.

For 50 points the Dwarf Admiral may purchase a contingent of Troll, Giant and Daemon Slayers for his flagship. These dauntless warriors do not count against the crew limitation and will add 1D3 to your combat total when you attack or defend, in addition to the normal +1 bonus. Since they are in thick of the fighting Slayers are sometimes the most endangered of all the combatants. When the ship takes a casualty in a boarding action roll a D6. A roll of 4+ indicates the Slayers are the casualties, remove the counter from the ships template. Slayers are never casualties by any other method, unless they are the only remaining crew counter on the ships template. Slayers are not sailors and a ship with only Slayers on board will move as a straggler.

MASTER ENGINEER	MASTER ENGINEER	MASTER ENGINEER	MASTER ENGINEER
RUNESMITH	SLAYERS	RUNE CANNON	RUNE CANNON
SPARE BOILER	SPARE BOILER	RUNE CANNON	RUNE CANNON

WEAPON
RUNE

WEAPON
RUNE

+0 BATTLE HONOURS 25 POINTS

Runes of Fortune

Shot marked with this magical sigil have a mind of their own. They growl and snarl as they are loaded and can change their course when fired at the enemy.

When you fire this ammunition you may add or subtract one from the to hit roll, making more likely to hit an already damaged location. A roll of one is still a miss.

RUNIC SHOT:

USE ONCE AND
DISCARD

+0 BATTLE HONOURS 25 POINTS

Runes of Smiting

This Runic ammunition has been toughened with an intensity found in the heart of a volcano. When they hit an enemy ship planking is split asunder and men are thrown from the decks in the storm of enchanted iron.

If a location fails its saving throw against this ammunition it will take two points of damage instead of one. Critical hits and all other rules for multiple damage apply.

RUNIC SHOT:

USE ONCE AND
DISCARD

WEAPON

RUNE

+1 BATTLE HONOUR 25 POINTS

Rune of Burning

When ammunition is loaded into a cannon bearing this Rune it starts to smoulder. Within a few seconds it blazes white hot but the powder is magically prevented from igniting until it is necessary.

Shots from this turret will set fire to the target ship. Place a Blaze counter instead of a normal Damage marker if it causes a hit.

WEAPON

RUNE

+1 BATTLE HONOUR 25 POINTS

Rune of Penetrating

Cannon bearing the markings of this Rune will magically toughen any ammunition they are loaded with, causing their shots to smash through armour and planking with greater ease.

Shots from this cannon have an additional -1 saving throw modifier. This is subject to other modifications such as Man O' War cards and range.

WEAPON

RUNE

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

Master Rune of Swiftncss

This Rune distorts time and space in its immediate vicinity. When used on a cannon it allows the crew to load and fire with a speed unachievable by natural training and experience.

A cannon marked with this Rune gains an extra shot in the Battle phase. This shot can be taken at any time, even while your opponent is using a ship. Simply declare that you are firing and follow the normal procedure. You may not interrupt an action if dice have already been rolled to determine its outcome. e.g. You may not interrupt firing if the to hit roll has been made but the saving throw is yet to be rolled.

HULL

RUNE

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

Master Rune of Gromril

The ships hull bends and twists itself under the magical influence of this Rune. Where gaping holes from battle damage have appeared it grows new plates and struts to repair the damage.

You may add +1 to the dice roll when you attempt to repair a ship location above the waterline.

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

Master Rune of Adamant

A ship with this Rune has its metallic skin toughened beyond belief. With the endurance of the roots of a mountain it withstands attack that would shatter lesser vessels.

The ship may re-roll any saving throws that it fails. If the second roll fails a hit is taken as normal. No saving throw can be re-rolled more than once, irrespective of the source of the re-roll. This Rune does not apply to below the waterline saves.

HULL
RUNE

+1 BATTLE HONOUR 25 POINTS

Rune of Piercing

This Rune glows with a menacing red hue which it casts onto the ships prow, enveloping it in the mystic aura. When the ship rams another vessel the ambient light blazes into a eye searing rainbow while the prow slides effortlessly through the opposing ships hull.

When this vessel rams another its target has an additional -1 modifier on its below the waterline saving throw.

HULL
RUNE

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

Rune of Spell Eating

The hull of the ship is covered by a shimmering curtain of energy. Spells cast at the ship are reflected harmlessly into the sky, away from the Dwarf fleet.

The ship may re-roll an attempt to dispel. It may only use the re-roll if the spell is directed at the ship with the Rune. If the second dispel roll fails the spell has its usual effect on the vessel.

HULL
RUNE

+1 BATTLE HONOUR 25 POINTS

Rune of Cleaving

The ships ram glints with a wicked sheen. When it comes into contact with an enemy ship it glows white and cuts its way through the planks and armour without stopping.

A Dwarf ship with this Rune may make a ram attack even if it has turned during the same Battle phase. The ship still needs to move 3 or more inches, but does not have to travel in a straight line. The ram is resolved as normal.

HULL
RUNE

MASTER ENGINEER CARD

+1 BATTLE HONOUR 25 POINTS

Flame Cannon

Mounted on the front of the ship a deadly Flame Cannon points its barrel menacingly at the enemy fleet.

The Flame Cannon is an additional weapon that is mounted in the Bows location and has a 180 degree fire arc to the front of the vessel. If the bows are destroyed so is the Flame Cannon. The Flame Cannon will be repaired at the same time as the Bows. It has a one dice attack and may fire at targets at a maximum of medium range and has no save modifier. If the target fails its save place a Blaze marker on the location.

MASTER ENGINEER CARD

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

Overdrive Engine

The Master Engineer on this vessel has installed a Thrumrocks triple gauged, double cam, loop-wired Overdrive engine.

A ship with an Overdrive engine may add 2" to all of its movement rates. If the ship is moving forward and does not turn it may add 4" to its movement value.

MASTER ENGINEER CARD

+1 BATTLE HONOUR 25 POINTS

Improved Gears

The gears and other systems that connect the two engines and allow the ship to turn have been improved as a result of diligent experimentation by the Master Engineer.

The ship may make turns between 90 and 180 degrees for half its movement, the same penalty as turns between 0 and 90 degrees.

MASTER ENGINEER CARD

+2 BATTLE HONOURS 50 POINTS

Spare Boiler

The Master Engineer has fitted a back-up boiler in case the main one is blown up.

If a ship with this card has its Boiler location destroyed place the Spare Boiler counter on the template instead of a normal Damage marker. The spare boiler does not benefit from any other engine improvements and will only move the vessel at normal speed. If the spare boiler is also destroyed the ship is immobilised as usual. The spare boiler may be repaired and counts as a separate location.